

EXTINCT SOUNDS

We were shocked to learn that some of our interns have never heard a dial-

tone in their lives. This BuzzFeed article seems to be apt for them as well. Born in the 90s – these sounds are almost on the verge of extinction thanks to advances in technology. Give it a listen.

http://dgit.in/wv_extinctsnds

ROBOT WARRIORS

The Pentagon has spent decades trying to get armed robots into service, but has been thwarted by worries about arming a semi-autonomous system but with MAARS and RAMP the future may finally be here. This fascinating update from Popular Mechanics is worth a read.

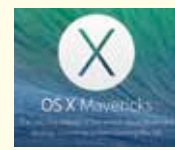
<http://dgit.in/robotzz>

UBUNTU EDGE

Ubuntu Edge is a desktop replacement smartphone that runs the Ubuntu Phone

OS, but automatically switches to a proper desktop Ubuntu OS when hooked up via HDMI. Sadly, it's destined to fail, find out why:

<http://dgit.in/ubntuzs>

OS X MAVERICKS PREVIEW

Eager to see what's in store for you with Apple's latest iteration of their

Macintosh operating system? For starters they ran out of cat names, and are naming it after places from now on. To know what's happening at the UI level, head over to:

<http://dgit.in/wMavericks>

Microsoft Research Faculty Summit

- Compiled by Siddharth Parwatay

Amongst all the events that shape the technology world, the more glamorous events like CES, E3, and WWDC tend to overshadow some of the smaller events that operate on a less grandiose scale but nonetheless bear a great significance on the development of core technology. One such confluence of the technology intelligentsia happens at the Microsoft Research Faculty Summit which is currently in its fourteenth year. Each year, Microsoft Research hosts a series of summits around the world. These events provide a forum for exploring research results and directions and foster conversations among scientists, faculty, and up-and-coming new students about cross-disciplinary opportunities. This year the summit happened at Microsoft's Redmond headquarters and brought together the who's who of thought leaders from academia, government, and leading institutes for the two day event.

The keynote

By far the biggest attraction at this year's summit was the keynote address by none other than Microsoft chairman, Bill Gates who makes his return to the summit after five long years. The keynote focussed on the contribution of computing to improving our world. Peppered with interesting perspectives Bill Gates shared his thoughts on computing's impact on society. You can watch the entire opening keynote here: <http://dgit.in/wbgates> which is hosted at Microsoft research in their virtual summit section. Alternatively here is the video hosted on YouTube:

<http://dgit.in/bgatesyout>

**The speakers and topics**

One of the most fascinating talks at the entire summit was delivered by Doug Burger (Microsoft Research) on how changes in the hardware ecosystem will disrupt computer science. He anticipates that from this point on, packing in more compute power into hardware, though achievable, will break our current notions of instruction sets, compilers, languages, data types, circuits, devices, and applications. Watch this video as he discusses the reasons for this shift, and makes some predictions about how it will affect the field of computer science:

<http://dgit.in/hardchng>

The next talk that you must watch is about an idea that Einstein once called "spooky". It's the idea of quantum computing – a branch that has garnered a great deal of interest over the past few years. The theory of bits simultaneously existing as a zero and one has blown our minds and we've delved into the subject several times in Digit. Watch this video as Krysta Svore of Microsoft Research, Scott Aaronson of

MIT, and Matthias Troyer of ETH Zurich discuss the latest breakthroughs in the field and the staggering possibilities it holds for computing in the future: <http://dgit.in/quantcomp>

The third and last talk we're featuring in this section is called "Prediction Engines", a discussion that deep dives into the science of predicting just about anything from stock markets to economic downturns to even horse races, by analysing data flows. Can the wisdom of the crowd really be broken down? Watch Robin Hanson of George Mason University, Sanmay Das of Virginia Tech, and David Pennock of Microsoft Research discuss the science behind prediction markets and how they can lead to better insight into the future: <http://dgit.in/12mzuoS>

The resources

If your appetite for cutting edge computer science is still not fulfilled, fear not, we have a whole bunch of resources for you to go through. First up, if you want to enjoy all of the recorded discussions at the summit head over to this link: <http://dgit.in/wvsummit>

You'll have a front row seat to discussions covering everything "Big Data Platforms" to "Deep Machine Learning" and "The Genomics Software Revolution". If you are still hungry for more Microsoft has a huge video repository of their research talks wherein researchers from their labs all over the world present their findings in an audio-visual format. The research lab in India has also put up 160 videos. Head on over to <http://dgit.in/16ewg3K> for more.